

Wgel

Security Assessment Report

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Methodology: PTES + MITRE ATT&CK;

Classification: Educational / TryHackMe Lab

This document presents a formalized penetration test report for the TryHackMe Wgel machine.

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1. Executive Summary

The Wgel assessment identified a chain of security weaknesses that allowed an attacker to move from unauthenticated access to root-level impact. The compromise relied primarily on information disclosure, credential exposure, SSH access, and a sudo misconfiguration.

Overall Risk	Critical
Initial Access	Exposed SSH private key
Privilege Escalation	sudo wget abuse
Final Impact	Root flag retrieval

2. Scope and Methodology

The objective was to obtain user and root access while documenting the attack path according to PTES phases.

3. Attack Path Overview

HTTP Enumeration → Username Disclosure → Directory Enumeration → Exposed SSH Key → SSH Access → sudo wget → Root Flag

4. Findings Summary

ID	Finding	Severity
WG-01	HTML Comment Information Disclosure	Low
WG-02	Exposed SSH Private Key	Critical
WG-03	Unauthorized SSH Access	High
WG-04	Privilege Escalation via wget	Critical

5. Detailed Findings

WG-01 - Information Disclosure

HTML comments exposed the username jessie, assisting later authentication attempts.

WG-02 - Exposed SSH Key

A private SSH key was exposed through the web application and allowed SSH authentication.

WG-03 - SSH Access

The recovered key provided interactive shell access to the host.

WG-04 - Sudo Misconfiguration

wget could be executed with elevated privileges, enabling root file exfiltration.

6. PTES Execution Narrative

Information gathering identified HTTP and SSH services. Web enumeration revealed sensitive information that disclosed a valid username. Further enumeration exposed an SSH private key, which enabled remote access. Local privilege enumeration identified a sudo rule involving wget that was abused to obtain the root flag.

7. MITRE ATT&CK; Mapping

Action	Technique
Network Enumeration	T1046
Web Enumeration	T1595
Information Disclosure	T1592
Exposed Credentials	T1552
SSH Access	T1021.004
Privilege Escalation	T1548

8. Remediation Roadmap

Remove sensitive files from web directories, eliminate exposed private keys, restrict sudo permissions, and review authentication mechanisms.

9. Evidence Appendix

Recommended evidence: Nmap output, Gobuster results, HTML source, SSH key disclosure, SSH shell, sudo output, and root flag retrieval.